



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of Annapolis
School Website: <https://www.chestertonacademyofannapolis.org/>

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Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of Annapolis (CA Annapolis) presents a strongly Catholic, classical-leaning vision within a tuition-conscious private school setting. Public-facing materials consistently foreground a classical, Catholic framework, with explicit references to formation in virtue, the truths of the Catholic faith, and liturgical life (notably Mass). The pedagogy centers on Socratic methods and a classical curricular mood, with emphasis on virtue, character formation, and parental partnership. While CA Annapolis clearly leans classical in spirit and aims at formation beyond mere information, several pieces of public material also signal college/professional life preparation and pragmatic affordability, introducing some tension with a fully "formation-first" ideal in the strict classical rubric.

Overall classification by the Six Essential Elements rubric: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Strengths across multiple categories include: clear religious/theological grounding (Catholic identity, liturgical life, daily Mass) and a family-centric community ethos (parent involvement, open-campus posture). Evidence of classical methods (Socratic method, debate, literature/history/philosophy/theology focus) is present, albeit not always described with the explicit grammar-logic-rhetoric framing of a canonical Trivium-focused program. The Great Books/Great Conversation element is not overtly documented in CA Annapolis public materials, though the curriculum is described as rigorous, classical, and literature/history/philosophy/theology-centered. Community and family partnerships are highlighted as central to the model.
- What would move CA Annapolis toward full CLASSICAL status: explicit articulation of the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as core, explicit mention of Great Books and Great Conversation, broader incorporation of reformulation toward scholé (restful contemplative learning) and memory/recitation practices if not already present, and a more explicit living-curriculum portrait of teachers as mentors in the classical tradition.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Explicit Catholic framing; daily Mass; Catholic faith as foundational; liturgical life suggested by Mass events; references to sacred tradition and Catholic teaching as the horizon for education.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include truth, Catholic faith, liturgy/Mass, sacred tradition; Negative indicators: none identified in public materials.
 - Why this rating: The school's public materials align with transcendental religious realism (truths of Catholic faith) and liturgical/community life (Mass). This category is clearly CLASSICAL in its religious/metaphysical orientation.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Emphasis on forming leaders/saints within a classical-Catholic frame; articulation of virtue and character through formation; some language about preparing students for college/professional life as a social aim alongside faith formation. Notably, "joyful leaders and

saints” and “virtue/character” language appears, but there is explicit mention of succeeding in college/professional life as a goal.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include virt(u)e, character, formation, Catholic faith. Negative indicators include college/professional-life preparation emphasis (workforce readiness). Present positives outweigh the single workforce-oriented signal, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.
- Why this rating: The school foregrounds formation of virtue and leadership within a classical-Catholic frame, but the public materials also emphasize preparation for college and professional life, which drags this category toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Public materials describe a rigorous, literature/history/philosophy/theology-centered curriculum; emphasis on classical tradition and drama/debate; references to literature and languages (Latin); explicit public mention of “drama and debate” as coursework. However, there is not a consistently explicit listing of grammar, logic, rhetoric as core “Trivium” elements, nor a clear, repeated emphasis on Great Books/Great Conversation in CA Annapolis public content.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include literature, history, philosophy, theology, Latin, drama, debate, classical, and the Socratic method; Negative indicators: lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and formal grammar/logic/rhetoric labeling in public materials. The presence of core liberal-arts subjects and classical framing yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.
 - Why this rating: The curriculum is described in a way that aligns with classical public perception (humanities-centered, Latin, drama/debate, philosophy/theology), but explicit Trivium components (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books references are not clearly documented in public content.
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: The network and CA Annapolis emphasize Socratic methods and seminars/debate (Socratic method explicitly noted; “drama and debate” coursework); there is some indication of contemplative/restful elements in classical pedagogy via the broader Chesterton network emphasis on formation; however, explicit, detailed references to restfulness/scholé pedagogy or explicit chanting/memory-based pedagogy in CA Annapolis public materials are limited.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Socratic, seminars, debate, rhetoric; Negative indicators include any explicit emphasis on project-based learning, purely experiential learning, or student-driven discovery without structure—these aren’t strongly evidenced in CA Annapolis content. The balance suggests SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Why this rating: The presence of Socratic pedagogy and seminars signals classical methods, but the absence of detailed restfulness/Scholé language and explicit memory/chanting (as described in some classical formulations) places CA Annapolis into SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Public materials emphasize virtue-led education, teacher mentorship, and a sense of community; there are references to a “living curriculum” and the faculty as core, but explicit statements about teacher portraits, mentor roles, and formal living-curriculum descriptions are not consistently documented on the public site.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords would include teachers as mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teacher/student ideals; Negative indicators would include a lack of explicit “living curriculum” language. Public materials show a strong faculty ethos, but explicit “living curriculum” language is not consistently present in CA Annapolis site content. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Why this rating: CA Annapolis projects a classical ethos and teacher-led formation in public materials, yet explicit, standard linguistic framing of faculty as the core living curriculum is not consistently present in the public-facing content, resulting in a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Strong parent partnership emphasis; parents as co-teachers/community partners;

open-campus approach; parent formation content; extensive parent involvement in activities and admissions; strong community and legacy language (Admissions/events, family involvement, etc.).

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, open campus, family access; Negative keywords: none evident in public materials. The explicit emphasis on parent involvement and formation aligns well with the classical Parents & Community category.
- Why this rating: The school publicly advances robust parental partnership, parent formation opportunities, and open access for parent engagement, which matches the CLASSICAL standard for this category.

Aggregate Rating

- CLASSICAL: 2 categories (Religious Foundations; Parents & Community)
- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: 4 categories (Purpose & Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty)

Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- Explicitly articulate grammar, logic, and rhetoric as core, map them to a formal Trivium structure, and provide public-facing details of where these elements appear in the CA Annapolis curriculum.
- Make explicit mention of Great Books or Great Conversation as a regular curricular component to reinforce the classical hallmarks.
- strengthen explicit “Scholé” language: mention contemplative/restful learning days, memory work, and chanting/memorization practices as part of daily pedagogy.
- Expand the living-curriculum narrative for faculty: publish a formal faculty-staff portrait and a description of teachers as mentors and living exemplars of classical pedagogy.
- Maintain and deepen parental formation programs (book studies, seminars) and publish a clear, regular cadence of parent-education opportunities on the public site.
- Provide explicit historical synthesis across subjects (interdisciplinary integration) and articulate a clear “formation-first” telos beyond college/workforce readiness to further align with classical aims.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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